UPSC Current Affairs

Thursday, 12 November 2026 · Sources: PIB and The Hindu · 20 items

Paper	Items	Top headlines
GS1	3	Drone industry needs deeper localisation as import dependenc; Cyclone Murasu damages over 274 hectares of crop area in Pra
GS2	11	Netanyahu dismisses claims that Israel blocking supplies to ; Consultations with Governor ongoing to arrive at agreement o
GS3	5	India, France hold dialogues on economic security, space, te; COP31 leaders urge focus on climate action despite global co
Prelims	1	Visions of the future: On this year's Booker Prize

Every item links to its original source: tap a headline or the Source line to open the full article on thehindu.com or the press release on pib.gov.in. The Hindu text here is only the short RSS excerpt.

GS Paper I: Heritage, Culture, History, Geography & Society

AGRICULTURE

Cyclone Murasu damages over 274 hectares of crop area in Prakasam district

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Agriculture, Geography

• District Agriculture Officer says maize suffered the maximum damage across 154.17 hectares, followed by paddy and cotton crops sown on 66.02 hectares and 49.78 hectares respectively; APCPDCL restores power across 613 cyclone-affected villages in the district

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Geography & disasters:** India is exposed to cyclones, floods and heatwaves; the Disaster Management Act, 2005 (amended 2025), NDMA and NDRF/SDRF lead the response.
• **Governance & polity:** Shift from relief to risk reduction (Sendai Framework); early warning, CDRI and climate-resilient infrastructure.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Cyclone Murasu, Prakasam, District Agriculture Officer, APCPDCL

Source: The Hindu, National, 11 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/andhra-pradesh/cyclone-murasu-damages-over-274hecta

ECONOMY

Drone industry needs deeper localisation as import dependence poses risks: DFI

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Economy, Geography, Polity & Constitution

• The dependence on foreign-made motors, batteries, flight controllers, communication systems and rare earth magnets leaves the sector vulnerable to supply disruptions and export restrictions, cautions Smit Shah, president, Drone Federation India

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Internal security:** Narco-terror links across the Punjab border (Golden Crescent) and in the North-East (Golden Triangle); drones are used to drop drugs and arms.
• **Society:** Drug abuse among youth; NDPS Act, 1985 and Nasha Mukt Bharat Abhiyaan.
• **Economy:** Affects India's export competitiveness, MSMEs and jobs in labour-intensive sectors; India's recent FTAs include UAE, Australia, EFTA (TEPA) and the UK.
• **International relations:** Trade is now a tool of geopolitics; India defends policy space at the WTO on food security (public stockholding) and agriculture.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Drone, DFI, Smit Shah, Drone Federation India

Source: The Hindu, National, 11 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/karnataka/drone-industry-needs-deeper-localisation-

GEOGRAPHY

Central committee suggests three-year roadmap to phase out unsustainable sand mining from active river channels

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Geography, International Relations, Economy

• In its report, the CEC observes that while sand and gravel are crucial ingredients for infrastructure and construction, their unscientific or excessive extraction from active channels and floodplains disrupts the delicate dynamic balance of river systems

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Economy:** RBI's MPC targets 4% CPI inflation (±2%); rate decisions affect EMIs, credit growth, investment and the rupee.
• **Society:** Food inflation hits poor households the most; links to supply-side measures like buffer stocks and export curbs.
• **Geography & disasters:** India is exposed to cyclones, floods and heatwaves; the Disaster Management Act, 2005 (amended 2025), NDMA and NDRF/SDRF lead the response.
• **Governance & polity:** Shift from relief to risk reduction (Sendai Framework); early warning, CDRI and climate-resilient infrastructure.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Central, CEC

Source: The Hindu, Environment, 11 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/central-committee-suggests-three-year-roadmap-to-ph

GS Paper II: Polity, Governance, Social Justice & IR

GOVERNANCE & SOCIAL JUSTICE

Consultations with Governor ongoing to arrive at agreement over V-C appointment: Higher Education Minister

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Governance & Social Justice, Polity & Constitution

• Consultations with Governor ongoing to arrive at agreement over V-C appointment: Higher Education Minister

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Governance & polity:** Role of the Governor in withholding assent to state bills (Article 200, 201) and Supreme Court guidance on timelines; tests cooperative federalism.
• **Ethics:** Constitutional morality: holders of constitutional office are expected to act neutrally and in good faith.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Consultations, Governor, V-C, Higher Education Minister

Source: The Hindu, National, 11 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/tamil-nadu/consultations-with-governor-ongoing-to-a

Government extends micro credit guarantee scheme for five years

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Governance & Social Justice, Economy, Science & Technology

• Collateral-free loans have created a whole new generation of entrepreneurs who previously could not avail loans from the formal banking system

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Collateral-free

Source: The Hindu, National, 11 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/government-extends-micro-credit-guarantee-scheme-fo

Chittoor, Annamayya mango growers fear dry spell, rainfall deficit likely to impact 2027 yields

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Governance & Social Justice, Agriculture

• Chittoor district alone has roughly 51,736 hectares planted with Totapuri mangoes, boasting an expected production capacity of 5.17 lakh tonnes; if the intense water crunch continues, Chittoor will easily see a 10% to 20% drop from its usual overall production, says an official from the Horticulture Department

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Chittoor, Annamayya, Totapuri, Horticulture Department

Source: The Hindu, National, 11 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/andhra-pradesh/chittoor-annamayya-mango-growers-fea

Anaemia prevention in India: pivoting towards better multidimensional strategies

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Governance & Social Justice, International Relations

• If anaemia reduction should align with India's goals for NCD reduction, then the focus must be on better diets through diversification.

• That should be non-negotiable for public health policy: no amount of papering over cracks with pills and potions will work in the long term

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Society:** Public health outcomes and out-of-pocket spending; schemes like Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY and the TB-elimination target.

• **Governance & polity:** Health is a State subject; centre–state coordination and the One Health approach for disease surveillance.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Anaemia, NCD, That

Static connect: Anaemia

• Anaemia Mukt Bharat strategy targets children, adolescents and women; NFHS data show high prevalence among women and children.

UPSC angle: Nutrition and health policy (GS2).

Source: The Hindu, Health, 11 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/anaemia-prevention-in-india-pivoting-towards-bett

Spain's first general strike in 14 years brings clashing social and political desires to the fore

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Governance & Social Justice, Science & Technology, Reports & Indices

• The two main unions calling for the strike, UGT and CCOO, reported widespread participation in the early hours "with significant work stoppages in strategic sectors"

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Economy:** RBI's MPC targets 4% CPI inflation (±2%); rate decisions affect EMIs, credit growth, investment and the rupee.

• **Society:** Food inflation hits poor households the most; links to supply-side measures like buffer stocks and export curbs.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Spain, UGT and CCOO

Source: The Hindu, International, 11 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/spains-first-general-strike-in-14-years-brings

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

Netanyahu dismisses claims that Israel blocking supplies to Gaza

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · International Relations, Economy

• Benjamin Netanyahu said the Palestinian militant group Hamas is to blame because it continues to refuse to disarm, a condition of the deal announced by Donald Trump, and seizes humanitarian aid in order to use it for military purposes

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Economy:** India imports most of its crude oil, much of it from the Gulf; conflict raises oil prices, shipping and insurance costs, inflation and the current account deficit.
• **Society:** About 9 million Indians live in the Gulf; their safety (evacuation operations such as Ajay/Kaveri) and remittances (India is the world's largest recipient) are at stake.
• **International relations:** India balances ties with Israel, Iran and the Arab states; projects like Chabahar and IMEC depend on regional stability.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Netanyahu, Israel, Gaza, Benjamin Netanyahu, Palestinian

Static connect: Gaza Strip

• Narrow Palestinian territory on the Mediterranean coast, bordering Israel and Egypt (Rafah crossing).
• India's long-standing position supports a two-state solution.

UPSC angle: India's West Asia policy and humanitarian law (GS2).

Source: The Hindu, International, 11 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/netanyahu-dismisses-claims-that-israel-blockin

Russia, Ukraine agree to major prisoner swap after U.S.-brokered talks in Abu Dhabi

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · International Relations

• The two sides have exchanged thousands of captured soldiers throughout the almost five-year war, started by Russia’s 2022 invasion

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Economy:** US is India's largest export market; tariffs, H-1B visa rules and trade-deal talks hit IT services, textiles, gems and pharma exports and the rupee.
• **International relations:** Comprehensive Global Strategic Partnership: defence deals, iCET/TRUST technology cooperation, Quad; India balances this with strategic autonomy (Russian oil, BRICS).
• **Internal security:** Dependence on Russian defence equipment (S-400, Su-30) and the push for indigenisation (Atmanirbhar Bharat in defence).

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Russia, Ukraine, Abu Dhabi

Source: The Hindu, International, 11 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/russia-ukraine-agree-to-prisoner-swap-at-us-br

POLITY & CONSTITUTION

Govt. clears infrastructure works for ■376 crore across State; roads set for upgrade

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Polity & Constitution, Economy

• clears 2,880 works to improve water supply, waterbodies, parks, and retaining walls in Chennai Corporation areas, other municipal corporations, municipalities, and town panchayats

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Govt, Chennai Corporation

Source: The Hindu, National, 11 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/cities/chennai/th-exclusive-from-cities-to-panchayats-cms-mi

ALSO IN THE NEWS (LOWER PRIORITY)

• DR Congo Ebola outbreak exceeds 11,000 cases, causes 5,387 deaths (The Hindu, International, 11 Nov 2026)
• ‘Iran will not allow enriched nuclear material to leave the country’ (The Hindu, International, 11 Nov 2026)
• New registration framework proposed to strengthen allied and healthcare professions in India (The Hindu, Health, 11 Nov 2026)

GS Paper III: Economy, Environment, S&T, Security & DM

ECONOMY

Milking power: On the overturning of Gokul Dairy cooperative mandate

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Economy, Agriculture

• The overturning of the mandate in the Gokul Dairy cooperative is disturbing

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Milking, Gokul Dairy

Source: The Hindu, Editorial, 11 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/opinion/editorial/milking-power-on-the-overturning-of-gokul-dairy

Tamil Nadu’s growing industrial water challenge

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Economy

• Weak water security threatens to undermine the State’s investment appeal and industrial growth prospects

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Tamil Nadu, Weak

Source: The Hindu, Lead (Op-Ed), 11 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/opinion/lead/tamil-nadus-growing-industrial-water-challenge/artic

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY

COP31 leaders urge focus on climate action despite global conflicts

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Environment & Ecology

• Negotiators from nearly 200 countries are seeking agreement at COP31 on a proposal from Turkey to increase the share of electricity in global ■energy use and revive stalled efforts to move away from fossil fuels

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Environment:** India's NDCs (45% cut in emission intensity of GDP from 2005 levels by 2030, 50% non-fossil power capacity, net zero by 2070) and the principle of CBDR-RC.
• **International relations:** India speaks for the Global South on climate finance and technology transfer; carbon border taxes like the EU's CBAM affect Indian exports.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: COP31, Negotiators, Turkey

Static connect: UNFCCC & Paris Agreement

• UNFCCC adopted at the 1992 Rio Earth Summit; the Conference of Parties (COP) meets yearly.
• Paris Agreement (COP21, 2015): keep warming well below 2°C, pursue 1.5°C; countries submit NDCs.
• India's targets include net zero by 2070.

UPSC angle: Climate negotiations and India's commitments (GS3).

Source: The Hindu, International, 11 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/war-conflict-must-not-distract-from-climate-ac

REPORTS & INDICES

Alice Huang, who reportedly had affair with Nvidia CEO, is Chinese banker turned tech exec

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Reports & Indices, Economy

• An affair between Nvidia's Jensen Huang and Alice Huang, who reportedly was suspected of working as a spy for Beijing, has rocked the tech and political worlds

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Economy:** RBI's MPC targets 4% CPI inflation (±2%); rate decisions affect EMIs, credit growth, investment and the rupee.
• **Society:** Food inflation hits poor households the most; links to supply-side measures like buffer stocks and export curbs.
• **Internal security:** Unsettled LAC (eastern Ladakh, Arunachal): border infrastructure, disengagement and buffer zones; China's dual-use villages (Xiaokang) and dams on the Brahmaputra (Yarlung Tsangpo).
• **International relations:** Strategic competition in the Indian Ocean (String of Pearls), BRI vs connectivity alternatives (IMEC), and balancing via Quad while engaging in BRICS/SCO.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Alice Huang, Nvidia CEO, Chinese, Nvidia, Jensen Huang and Alice Huang

Source: The Hindu, International, 11 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/alice-huang-who-reportedly-had-affair-with-nvi

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

India, France hold dialogues on economic security, space, technology

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Science & Technology, Economy, Agriculture

• The two sides discuss supply chain vulnerabilities, critical technologies, cybersecurity and safeguarding strategic supplies, as part of the India-France Economic Security and Critical Technologies Dialogue

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Internal security:** Cyber attacks on critical infrastructure and fraud like 'digital arrest' scams; CERT-In, NCIIPC and I4C are the response agencies.
• **Governance & polity:** IT Act 2000, Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023, and the need for cyber hygiene and capacity in state police.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: France, India-France Economic Security and Critical Technologies Dialogue

Source: The Hindu, National, 11 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/india-france-hold-dialogues-on-economic-security-sp

Prelims Facts: Reports, Indices, Awards

AWARDS, DAYS & PERSONS

Visions of the future: On this year’s Booker Prize

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Awards, Days & Persons

• This year’s Booker Prize betrays an anxiety about AI’s place in society

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Visions, Booker Prize

Source: The Hindu, Editorial, 11 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/opinion/editorial/visions-of-the-future-on-this-years-booker-priz